

Cover story **INDO-US RELATIONS**

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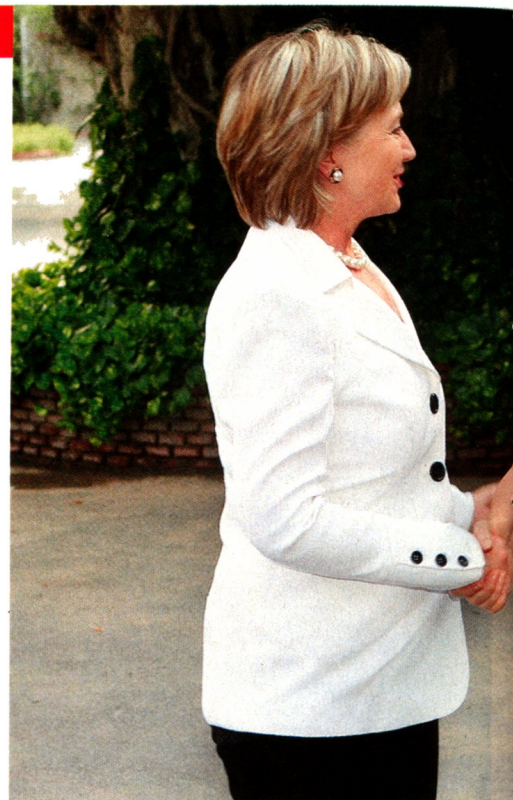
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(TOP) HILLARY WITH MEMBERS OF SEWA, AN NGO; (ABOVE) SIGNING THE CONDOLENCE BOOK AT THE TAJ MAHAL HOTEL IN MUMBAI; WITH SONIA GANDHI IN DELHI

NO BIG DEAL

- On terrorism, no specific assurance to tie aid to Pakistan with action against terrorist groups working against India.
- Differences persist on climate change; India says no to cutting emissions till the developed world makes concessions.
- Agree on a End Use Monitoring Agreement for sale of US defence equipment. The controversial agreement has some restrictive clauses on the use of equipment and US inspectors can monitor it.
- Despite strategic ties, Indian government companies still on the US blacklist that bans trade in sensitive dual-use technology.



Singh reciprocated by doing away with protocol and hosting a private lunch for her. He then provided the icing on the cake by telling her that his Government had identified sites in Andhra Pradesh and Gujarat for two US nuclear power plants—an economic deliverable Hillary wanted to take back home since it will provide billions of dollars to US companies and jobs for its badly affected nuclear industry. When Hillary met UPA Chairperson Sonia Gandhi and her son Rahul, she thanked her for the role she played in making the Indo-US relationship stronger. She spent more than an hour with Sonia, nodding in agreement as the latter shared her concerns about the continuing terrorism from Pakistan. But it went little beyond more than a few words of sympathy.

But on big ticket issues like climate change, the differences were visible when Minister of Environment and Forests Jairam Ramesh told her, "There is simply no case for the pressure that we, who have among the lowest emissions per capita, face to actually reduce emissions... We also face the threat of carbon

tariffs on our exports to countries such as yours." On the issue of terrorism, she demonstrated a great degree of symbolism, preferring to start her five-day visit from Mumbai. She chose to stay at the Taj Mahal Hotel to send a message that the US stood behind India in bringing the perpetrators of 26/11 attacks to justice. "Let us rid the world of hatred and extremism that produces such nihilistic violence. Our future deserves no less," she wrote in the condolence book.

Though the US has been more sensitive to India's concerns post-26/11, still no assurances were given that it would tie the aid to Pakistan with a condition that it takes military action against terror groups. But Hillary did assure her Indian interlocutors that the US will work towards the adoption of a UN Comprehensive Convention against International Terrorism, which has been proposed by India. But even amid signs of disagreement and the US being reticent to address its concerns, India played a good host. Even before she arrived, the prime minister returned from Sharm-el-